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Credit - Drishti Ias

Long-Term Strategic Vision and Land Warfare Doctrine

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Source: PIB

The Defence Minister addressed the Army Commanders' Conference in New Delhi, where he unveiled the **Land Warfare Doctrine 2026** .

- **Need for a 20-30 Year Vision:** Given the rapid shifts in global geopolitics and military technology, the Defence Minister stressed that ad-hoc planning must be replaced with a **long-term strategic blueprint (20-30 years)** to future-proof the armed forces.
  - Emphasizing that **modern warfare** is constantly evolving, noted that military strategies cannot be static. They must remain highly flexible and dynamic to enable timely adjustments to changing operational circumstances.
- **Year of Reforms:** Referring to **2025 as the 'Year of Reforms,'** the Defence Minister urged commanders to ensure that structural and administrative reforms translate into tangible operational capabilities on the ground.
- **Multi-Domain Operations (MDO):** Emphasised jointness across military branches, the continued importance of ground forces, and the integration of emerging technologies such as **Artificial Intelligence (AI), autonomous weapon systems (drones),** data analytics, cybersecurity, and secure communication networks.
- **Aatmanirbharta in Defence (Self-Reliance):** Celebrated massive milestones in indigenisation, noting that **defence production reached a record Rs 1.78 lakh crore** and **defence exports hit an all-time high of Rs 38,000 crore** in FY 2025-26.
- **Global Peacekeeping Footprint:** Released the annual **United Nations Journal** and felicitated Indian Army personnel for their exemplary contributions to **UN Peacekeeping missions** and international security.

Land Warfare Doctrine 2026

- **About:** The land warfare doctrine provides a strategic framework for preparing and conducting land-based operations, **integrating unmanned systems, manned-unmanned teaming (MUM-T), and resilient logistics** to address future conflicts.
- **Strategic Context:** The doctrine updates the previous 2018 version, drawing crucial lessons from the **prolonged standoff with China along the Line of Actual Control (LAC)** , recent global conflicts (**Russia-Ukraine** , **Iran-US**), and **Operation Sindoor** against Pakistan.
- **Centrality of Land Power:** Despite the rise of new warfare domains, the doctrine reiterates the **continued centrality of land power** in achieving decisive military and political outcomes.

Read more: AI-Driven Warfare: Preparing India for Future Combat Readiness

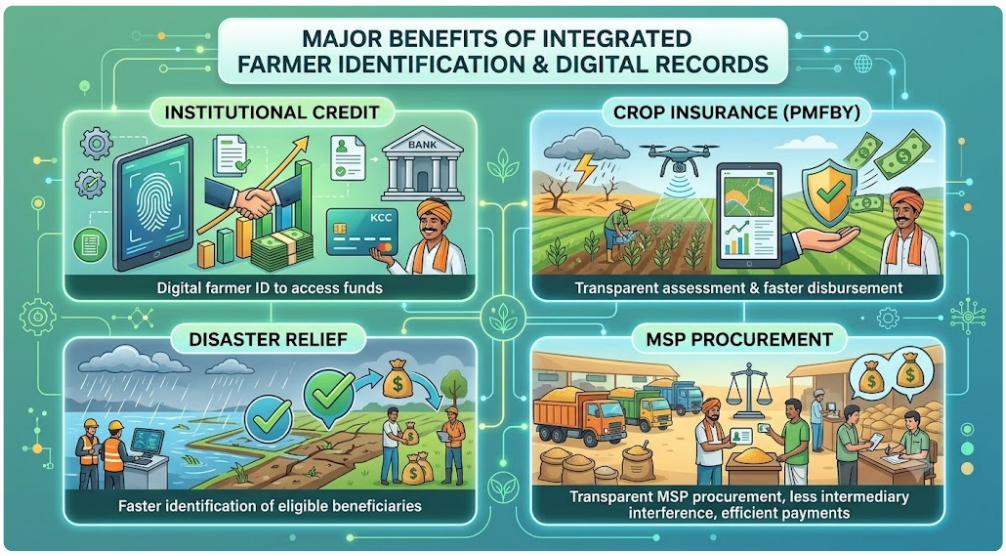
India Achieves 11 Crore Farmer IDs Under Digital Agriculture Mission

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Source: PIB

The **Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare achieved the target of creating 11 crore Farmer IDs under the Digital Agriculture Mission** , five months ahead of the 31st March 2027 deadline.

- **Achievement:** The target was completed on 23rd October 2026, with over 6 crore farmers already receiving benefits through Farmer ID-based service delivery.
- **About Farmer ID:** A **unique digital identity for farmers,** created by linking farmers' details with their digitised land records under the Farmer Registry of **AgriStack,** facilitating access to agricultural services and government schemes.



Digital Agriculture Mission

- **About:** Approved by the Union Cabinet on **2nd September 2024, under the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare,** with a total outlay of ₹2,817 crore, including a central share of ₹1,940 crore **.**
- **Objective:** Develop **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for agriculture** to enable data-driven governance, efficient service delivery and farmer-centric digital solutions.
- **Key Components:**
  - **AgriStack:** Includes the **Farmer Registry, Geo-referenced Village Maps and Crop Sown Registry** , created and maintained by States/UTs.
  - **Krishi Decision Support System (Krishi DSS):** Integrates satellite imagery, weather, soil, reservoir and groundwater data to support **crop mapping, yield estimation, drought/flood monitoring and evidence-based agricultural planning** .
  - **Soil Profile Mapping:** Supports village-level mapping of soil characteristics for sustainable land use

and crop planning.

Read More: **Sansad TV Vishesh: Digital Agriculture Mission**

RBI’s Data Centre and Cybersecurity Training Institute

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Source: PIB

Recently, the Prime Minister inaugurated the **Reserve Bank of India ’s** newly established **Data Centre and Cybersecurity Training Institute** in Bhubaneswar, Odisha.

- **Key Features:** The ₹169-crore project includes **four state-of-the-art data centres,** certified to the **Uptime Institute's Tier IV standard, the highest tier for data-centre infrastructure resilience.**
- **Critical Financial Infrastructure:** The facility will support **mission-critical payment and settlement systems,** including **NEFT** and **RTGS ,** along with **RBI's e-Kuber** platform for government banking operations, enhancing operational continuity and reducing service disruptions.
- **Digital Sovereignty:** The RBI-operated facility will function **independently of third-party cloud service providers,** strengthening control over critical financial infrastructure.
- **Cybersecurity Training Institute:** It will provide specialised training and research opportunities for **RBI personnel, banks and other financial-sector institutions,** focusing on **Artificial Intelligence, Big Data Analytics , Quantum Computing and Blockchain .**
- **Disaster Resilience:** Bhubaneswar offers **geographical separation** from RBI's three existing data centres in Maharashtra and is situated in a **different seismic zone, reducing the risk of simultaneous disruptions.**
- **Significance:** The facilities will **strengthen financial-system resilience, cybersecurity preparedness, digital sovereignty** and **institutional capacity** , supporting secure and reliable financial services.

Read more: **India's Cybersecurity Challenge: Threats and Strategies**